expressed in the geopolitical thought of Nicholas Spykman during the 1940s. The great power struggles in the long twentieth century (starting with the Sino-Japanese War of 1894) centered more on control of the inner seas and littoral rimlands than on the heartland of Halford Mackinder's more famous formulation. To see Asia as an integrated strategic space may offer new avenues for maintaining stability and understanding the scope of China's bid for regional hegemony.

That discussion is followed by a piece laying out what I call the "new China rules," by which Beijing hopes to deal with the world, including pervasive espionage, stealing of intellectual property, intimidation, and further shutting off of China from the outside, all policies being pushed by Chinese president Xi Jinping. The third essay argues that the greatest threat from a nuclear North Korea is not that Kim Jong-un or his successors will one day decide to nuke San Francisco, but rather that maintaining a nuclear arsenal is an extraordinarily difficult job, one in which the risk of accidents and miscalculations is frighteningly high, as attested by the history of the American nuclear arms program. If the world does not succeed in denuclearizing North Korea, then it will have to trust Pyongyang to know how to keep its nuclear weapons safe from malfunction, accidental launch, and the like.

The next two chapters are largely focused on domestic affairs in India and Japan. I wrote "India's Missing Women" from a journalistic standpoint, based on interviews I conducted in New Delhi and Chennai a few years ago. Though India is steadily increasing its global role, social attitudes at home continue to change too slowly to benefit millions of educated women, who often continue to be forced into arranged marriages and who have to give up their professional careers. Until India taps into the skills and talents of these women, it will continue to lag in development. In a similar vein, "Japan's Eightfold Fence" is a sweeping reconsideration of how Japan has embraced "modernity" and how that has shaped its response to a generation of economic stagnation. In looking over the past twenty-five years of Japanese history, the essay argues that the Japanese have consciously made a choice to maintain certain barriers against the world so as to preserve social stability and